

ProShop in 10 minutes

The context you need before the personas make sense: what ProShop is, who buys it, and how a job moves through a machine shop.

WHAT PROSHOP IS

ProShop is an all-in-one, paperless **operating system for precision machine shops**. Before ProShop, a shop runs on spreadsheets, whiteboards, paper travelers, email threads, and the tribal knowledge in a veteran machinist's head. ProShop replaces that with a single connected system where the quote becomes the work order becomes the schedule becomes the inspection record becomes the invoice — with no duplicate data entry and a complete audit trail.

It's really three products in one, which is why customers rarely outgrow it:

ERP

ENTERPRISE RESOURCE PLANNING

The business backbone — quoting, orders, purchasing, inventory, scheduling, job costing, and invoicing. The record of *what the shop is doing and what it costs*.

MES

MANUFACTURING EXECUTION SYSTEM

The shop-floor layer — live work-order status, operator time tracking, scheduling dashboards, and work instructions. The record of *how the work is running right now*.

QMS

QUALITY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

The compliance layer — inspection plans, calibration, cert packets, non-conformance, audits, and procedures. The record of *proving the parts meet spec*.

WHO IT'S FOR

Small-to-medium **precision manufacturing shops** — often 5 to 150 people — making high-mix, low-to-medium-volume machined parts to tight tolerances. The stakes are highest in regulated industries, where traceability and compliance aren't optional:

Aerospace · AS9100

Defense · ITAR / CMMC

Medical · ISO 13485 / FDA

Space · full traceability

THE CORE PROMISE

Ditch the spreadsheets

One integrated system replaces five or six disconnected tools — no duplicate entry, no clunky integrations, fully paperless.

See the whole shop live

A real-time view of who's working on what, which jobs are on track, and where bottlenecks are forming — proactive, not reactive.

Prove quality by default

Compliance is built in, so audits are calm and the team makes parts instead of chasing paper trails.

Capture tribal knowledge

Tricks of the trade get documented in the system, so the shop doesn't lose decades of know-how when a veteran retires.

HOW A JOB MOVES THROUGH THE SHOP

Every persona in this series sits somewhere along this four-stage journey. It's the map to keep in your head — a job travels left to right, and each role hands the next one a more finished version of the same record.

Stage 1 Pre-Production	Stage 2 Procurement	Stage 3 Production	Stage 4 Post-Production
Estimator · Order Entry · Planner	Buyer · Receiver	Scheduler · Tool Crib · Operator	QA · Inventory · Shipping · Accounting
- RFQ scoped & quoted - Won quote → work order - Config plan finalized	- Demand queued from WOs - Vendor POs placed - Material received & inspected	- Setup & first article - Machining & in-process checks - Teardown & traceability	- Final inspection & cert packet - Pack, label & ship - Invoice & close

THE ONE THING TO REMEMBER

ProShop's whole value is that **these stages share one database**. What the Estimator assumes becomes the Operator's target. What the Receiver uploads becomes the cert packet the Shipper sends. Each persona works from a different dashboard, but they're all filtered views of the same work orders — so a change one person makes, everyone downstream sees.

THE VOCABULARY YOU'LL HEAR CONSTANTLY

RFQ Request for Quote — a customer asking “what would this part cost?”	PO Purchase Order — the customer's formal commitment to buy.
WO Work Order — the internal job record that runs the part.	Op Operation — one step in making a part (mill, turn, inspect).
OSP Outside Processing — steps sent to a vendor (anodize, plating).	COTS Commercial Off-The-Shelf — stock hardware bought, not made.
FAI First Article Inspection — proving the first part meets every dim.	IPC In-Process Check — spot inspection while a run is going.
NCR Non-Conformance Report — logged when a part is out of tolerance.	CFC / C of C Certificate of Conformance — the shop attesting parts meet spec.
Cert packet The bundle of proof (certs, forms, results) shipped with parts.	Traceability The unbroken paper trail from raw material to finished part.

THE PRODUCT SURFACE, BY MODULE

When a persona says they “live in” a part of ProShop, it maps to one of these modules. This is the product map for navigating both the org and the roadmap.

Estimating & Quoting Estimator	Sales & Work Orders Order Entry, Planner
Shop Floor & Scheduling Scheduler, Operator	Visual Work Instructions Planner, Operator
Inventory & Material Planning Buyer, Receiver, Inventory	Tool & Fixture Management Tool Crib, Operator
Quality Systems & Inspection QA	Calibration & Preventative QA
Job Costing & Financial Data Accounting, Estimator	Data Management All roles

WHO PROSHOP IS, AS A COMPANY

Context that helps a new hire understand not just the product, but the company building it and the customers it serves.

COMPANY MISSION

"We build powerful manufacturing software by deeply understanding our clients' challenges, in order to meaningfully improve their businesses, and in turn their communities."

BY MACHINISTS, FOR MACHINISTS

ProShop wasn't built by a software company that discovered manufacturing — it was built by machinists who got tired of running a shop on spreadsheets. That origin is the whole reason the product fits the way it does.

1997

Pro CNC machine shop founded.

2000

Outgrew Excel; began building ProShop.

2008

First external ProShop ERP client.

2014

Sold the Pro CNC machine shop.

2016

Launched as a software company (then Adion).

2026

600+ clients, 100+ employees.

WHO BUYS PROSHOP — THE IDEAL CUSTOMER

ProShop deliberately targets **high-stakes machine shops** — not “anyone with a machine,” but shops where a mistake could be catastrophic, and growing mid-market shops where tribal knowledge is starting to break the business.

BULLSEYE

Industry: Aerospace, Defense, Medical
Size: 20–75 employees
Compliance: AS9100, ITAR, CMMC, ISO 13485 (mandatory)
Pain: “We lose contracts if we fail audits.”

STRONG FIT

Industry: Industrial, Auto, Robotics, Energy, Oil & Gas
Size: 10–19 or 76–150 employees
Compliance: ISO 9001, or aspiring to bullseye certs
Pain: “Manual errors are killing our margin.”